

Ch 4: Gender, Religion and Caste

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A - 2 MARKS

**Q1. What is sexual division of labour? Give two examples.
(PYQ)**

**Q2. What is a feminist? What do feminist movements aim at?
(PYQ 2014)**

**Q3. What is sex ratio? What is the sex ratio of India as per
Census 2011?**

**Q4. Name two countries where participation of women in public
life is very high.**

**Q5. What percentage of Lok Sabha members are women in
India? Why is this considered inadequate?**

**Q6. What is the Women's Reservation Bill? What does it
propose?**

Q7. What is patriarchal society? Give two features of it.

**Q8. What is communalism? What is the distinguishing feature
of communal politics? (PYQ 2014)**

Q9. What is a secular state? Give one example.

Q10. Name three provisions of the Indian Constitution that make it a secular state.

Q11. What are family laws? What matters do they deal with?

Q12. What is casteism? Give one example of how it affects Indian politics.

Q13. What is untouchability? Is it practised legally in India today?

Q14. What is a caste hierarchy? What was the traditional caste system based on?

Q15. What is meant by 'caste census'? Why is it controversial?

Q16. What is the difference between caste as a social institution and caste in politics?

Q17. Name two forms in which communalism appears in politics.

Q18. Suppose a politician seeks your vote on religious grounds. Why is this act against the norms of democracy? (PYQ)

Q19. What is the Equal Wages Act? What does it provide?

Q20. What is gender division? Is it based on biology or social expectations? (PYQ 2016-17)

Q21. Name two ways in which women face discrimination in the workplace in India.

Q22. What are the three aspects of life covered in this chapter that affect Indian democracy?

Q23. What is meant by 'majority community' in the context of communalism? Give one example from India.

Q24. Why do we discuss household work in a textbook on Political Science? *(PYQ NCERT)*

Q25. What does the 42nd Constitutional Amendment of 1976 say about India being a secular state?

Q26. Name two caste-based political terms used to group castes in India — one for upper castes and one for lower castes.

Q27. What are the literacy rates of men and women in India? What does the difference indicate?

Q28. What are 'backward' and 'forward' caste groups? How have they emerged in Indian politics?

Q29. Give two examples of how caste identities are used during elections in India.

Q30. Name two Scandinavian countries where women's participation in public life is notably high.

Q31. What is communal violence? Give one historical example from India.

SECTION B - 3 MARKS

- Q1. Explain the concept of sexual division of labour with an example. What are the results of this concept? (PYQ — frequently asked)**
- Q2. "Women in Indian society still suffer from discrimination and oppression." Support with three examples. (PYQ)**
- Q3. Mention any three aspects of life in which women are discriminated against or disadvantaged in India. (PYQ)**
- Q4. Suggest any three measures to improve women's participation in politics. (PYQ)**
- Q5. How did feminist movements help improve the role of women in public life? Explain three outcomes. (PYQ 2014)**
- Q6. What is communalism? Explain three forms it takes in politics. (PYQ 2016-17)**
- Q7. How can communalism take various forms in politics? Explain with examples. (PYQ 2016-17)**
- Q8. What is a secular state? Explain three factors which make India a secular state. (PYQ 2016-17)**
- Q9. How does the Constitution of India safeguard the principles of secularism? Explain three provisions. (PYQ)**
- Q10. "Caste has not disappeared from contemporary India." Justify with three examples. (PYQ)**

**Q11. How does caste get politicised in India? Give three points.
(PYQ)**

Q12. Describe three forms in which caste appears in politics in India. (PYQ)

Q13. Explain how caste inequalities still continue in India despite constitutional protections. Give three examples.

Q14. Why is gender division a form of hierarchical social division? Explain three points.

**Q15. "Gender division is not based on biology but on social expectations and stereotypes." Support with three arguments.
(PYQ 2016-17)**

Q16. Explain the difference between communalism and secularism. How does India try to maintain a balance?

Q17. Explain three ways in which political parties have tried to use caste to gain electoral support.

Q18. Explain three ways in which caste and politics influence each other in India.

Q19. Explain three ways in which political parties in India try to address the aspirations of different caste groups.

Q20. How does economic inequality reinforce caste inequality in India? Explain three points.

Q21. Explain three constitutional provisions that ensure gender equality in India.

Q22. Why is communalism considered dangerous for democracy? Explain three reasons.

Q23. Explain how caste can both unite and divide people in Indian politics. Give three examples.

Q24. How has the rise of Dalit movements and OBC politics changed the nature of caste in Indian democracy? Give three points.

Q25. "If casteism and communalism are bad, what makes feminism a good thing?" Answer this with three arguments. (PYQ NCERT)

Q26. Explain three ways in which women in India are disadvantaged compared to men in the economic sphere.

Q27. Explain how communalism affects the democratic process. Give three examples of communal politics in India.

Q28. Explain the concept of secularism as practised in India. How is it different from Western secularism?

Q29. Explain three ways in which caste consciousness among voters can affect the outcome of elections in India.

Q30. Explain how women's reservation in local government bodies has changed political participation at the grassroots level. Give three points.

Q31. Explain three limitations of the Women's Reservation Bill and why it has not been passed for so long.

Q32. How does religion enter politics in India? Explain three specific ways.

Q33. Explain the relationship between caste, class, and political power in India. Give three examples.

Q34. How has migration and urbanisation changed the nature of caste in modern India? Explain three points.

Q35. Explain three measures the government has taken to reduce caste-based discrimination in India.

Q36. Explain how caste-based coalitions work during elections. Give two examples from Indian politics.

Q37. Explain three ways in which communal thinking can be distinguished from religious belief.

Q38. How do family laws in India differ for different religious communities? Give three examples.

Q39. Explain three ways in which the political expression of gender issues has been healthy for democracy in India.

Q40. How has the caste system changed from its traditional form to its modern political expression? Explain three changes.

Q41. Explain three ways in which a secular state is different from a theocratic state. Give one example of each.

Q42. Describe three ways in which women's movements in India have contributed to changes in law and policy.

SECTION C - 5 MARKS

Q1. "Women in India face disadvantage, discrimination and oppression in various ways." Support this statement with five examples covering literacy, employment, sex ratio, political representation, and wages. (PYQ — *most repeated*)

Q2. Explain the concept of sexual division of labour. What are its consequences for women's role in politics and public life? What measures can improve women's political representation? (PYQ)

Q3. Explain how communalism can take various forms in politics. Why is communalism considered a threat to democracy? Give five points. (PYQ 2016-17)

Q4. What is a secular state? Explain five provisions of the Indian Constitution that make India a secular state. (PYQ 2016-17)

Q5. Explain the relationship between caste and politics in India. How does caste get politicised? Describe five forms in which caste appears in Indian politics. (PYQ — *frequently asked*)

Q6. "Caste has not disappeared from contemporary India." Justify with five examples showing how caste still affects education, employment, marriage, politics, and social life.

Q7. Explain the feminist movement. How has the political expression of gender issues helped women in India? Give five specific changes brought about by women's movements.

Q8. Explain the difference between communalism and secularism. How has India tried to maintain secularism despite religious diversity? Give five specific examples.

Q9. "Gender division is not based on biology but on social expectations and stereotypes." Explain this statement and describe five ways in which gender inequality manifests in Indian society.

Q10. Compare the political representation of women in India with two other countries. What are the reasons for low women's representation in India? Suggest five measures to improve it.

Q11. Explain five ways in which caste and class together determine life chances and political power in India.

Q12. How does religion enter politics in India? Explain both the positive and negative expressions of religion in politics with five examples each.

Q13. "Communal politics is based on the idea that religion is the principal basis of social community." Explain this statement and describe five forms of communalism that threaten Indian democracy.

Q14. Explain the concept of gender division. How has it shaped the public-private divide in Indian society? Give five specific examples showing how this divide affects women's lives.

Q15. Explain how democratic politics in India has both reflected and transformed caste identities. Give five examples of how political movements have used caste as a tool for social empowerment.

Q16. "Feminism, unlike casteism and communalism, is not a divisive force but an inclusive one." Justify this statement with five arguments.

Q17. Describe how caste-based mobilisation has both strengthened and weakened democracy in India. Give five examples covering Dalit movements, OBC politics, and upper caste backlash.

Q18. Explain how India's Constitution tries to prevent communalism while still respecting religious freedom. Give five specific constitutional provisions and their significance.

Q19. "Women's political representation in India is far below what is needed for true democracy." Discuss this statement with five arguments covering Lok Sabha, state assemblies, local bodies, and international comparisons.

Q20. Explain the relationship between gender, caste, and class as overlapping social inequalities in India. How do they together affect the life of a poor Dalit woman? Give five specific examples.

Q21. How have Dalit communities used democratic politics to challenge caste discrimination in India? Trace the journey from

Ambedkar's movements to modern OBC politics with five examples.

Q22. "Social divisions based on caste are peculiar to India." Discuss this statement — is it accurate? How does the Indian caste system differ from social stratification in other countries?

Q23. Explain how women's reservation in Panchayati Raj institutions has changed political participation at the grassroots level in India. What are its achievements and limitations?

Q24. Describe the three major social divisions covered in this chapter — gender, religion, and caste. Explain how each affects democratic politics in India and what measures have been taken to address each.

Q25. "Democracy is about more than just elections — it is about ensuring equal dignity and rights for all social groups." Justify this statement with reference to gender equality, secularism, and caste justice in India.